NO BASICS · ONLY ADVANCED

ADVANCED SEO NOTES

Semantic SEO · Topical Authority · Topical Map
Entity SEO · Information Retrieval · Link Architecture
Crawl & Index · AI Search

SAVE THIS →



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SEMANTIC SEO

LEVEL: ADVANCED ●●●

Search engines now read meaning, not just matching words. They map **entities**, their attributes and how they relate. Semantic SEO means writing for that layer.

THE ENTITY–ATTRIBUTE–VALUE MODEL (EAV)

ENTITY	ATTRIBUTE	VALUE
Linen duvet cover	Material	100% stonewashed linen
Linen duvet cover	Size	King, 230 × 220 cm
Linen duvet cover	Care	Machine wash at 40°C
Linen	Origin	European flax

HOW TO APPLY IT

- Cover the attributes shoppers and search engines expect
- Write clear, factual sentences: subject → attribute → value
- Answer the questions people ask next (PAA, related searches)
- Keep terms consistent: one name per thing

GIVE MACHINES FACTS THEY CAN EXTRACT.



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TOPICAL AUTHORITY

LEVEL: ADVANCED ●●●

Topical authority is when search engines trust your site as a go-to source for a whole topic, not just one keyword.

COVERAGE
Every subtopic and question handled

→

DEPTH
Each page more useful than rivals

→

CONSISTENCY
Pages kept fresh over time

SIGNALS THAT BUILD IT

SIGNAL	WHAT IT MEANS
Topical coverage	You answer the full range of questions in your niche
User signals	Shoppers return to and engage with your pages
Topical focus	Content stays inside your store's niche
Internal links	Related pages link in a logical path

EXAMPLE A store with 40 linked pages on **espresso grinders** (burr types, grind size, cleaning, A vs B) usually outranks one long “ultimate guide”.

OWN THE TOPIC, NOT ONE KEYWORD.



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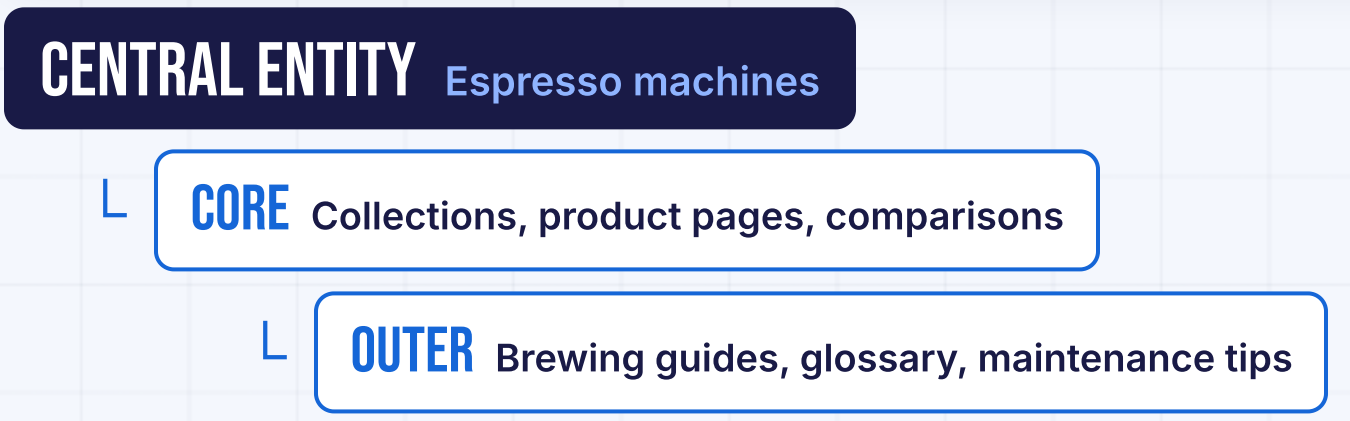
TOPICAL MAP

LEVEL: ADVANCED ●●●

A **topical map** is the plan for your whole content network. Build it **before** you write a single page.

THE 5 PARTS OF A TOPICAL MAP

PART	MEANING
Source context	Why the site exists and how it makes money (e.g. a coffee equipment store)
Central entity	The main thing every page connects to
Core section	Pages closest to revenue: collections and products
Outer section	Supporting guides that widen topical coverage
Contextual bridges	Links that move readers from one subtopic to the next



MAP FIRST. WRITE SECOND.



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ENTITY SEO

LEVEL: ADVANCED ● ● ●

Make your **brand and authors** clear entities so search engines can connect them in their knowledge graph.

1. **Organization schema** with name, logo, address and **sameAs** profiles
2. One stable **@id** that links your schema across pages
3. **Person schema** for authors, backed by a real author page
4. **about** and **mentions** to state each page's main entities
5. The same name, address and phone number everywhere
6. Profiles on LinkedIn, Crunchbase and Wikidata where you qualify

SCHEMA SNIPPET

```
"@type": "Organization",
"@id": "https://yourstore.com/#org",
"sameAs": ["linkedin.com/company/…", "instagram.com/…"]
```

BECOME AN ENTITY, NOT JUST A WEBSITE.



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INFORMATION RETRIEVAL

LEVEL: ADVANCED ●●●

Learn how search engines **retrieve and rank** content, then write for that process.

CONCEPT	WHAT TO DO
Passage ranking	Keep one idea per section so a single passage can rank on its own
Information gain	Bring something new: your own data, tests, photos
Query rewriting	Cover synonyms, variations and the next question
Intent shift	Match what the results page shows: list, guide, tool or video
Freshness	Refresh pages for trending and seasonal searches
Chunking	Short, self-contained sections AI tools can quote

INFORMATION GAIN TEST If your page repeats what the top 10 results already say, it adds nothing new. **What can your store add that they can't?**

NO NEW INFORMATION, NO REASON TO RANK.



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INTERNAL LINK ARCHITECTURE

LEVEL: ADVANCED ● ● ●

Internal links pass **authority and context**. Plan them like site architecture, not as an afterthought.

RULE	WHY IT MATTERS
Crawl depth ≤ 3 clicks	Deeper pages get crawled and valued less
Links in the body copy	Carry more meaning than footer links
Descriptive, varied anchors	Tell search engines what the target page is about
Link up to revenue pages	Send authority to collections and products
Fix orphan pages	Pages with no internal links are hard to find
One page per intent	Prevents keyword cannibalisation

PRO METHOD In Search Console, find the page with the most backlinks. Add **2–3 in-body links** from it to the products or collections you want to rank next.

LINKS SHOW SEARCH ENGINES WHAT MATTERS MOST.



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CRAWL, RENDER & INDEX

LEVEL: ADVANCED ● ● ●

Search engines can't crawl every URL on a big store. **Decide what** gets crawled, rendered and indexed.

AREA	ADVANCED PRACTICE
Log file analysis	Shows which URLs Googlebot visits and how often
Crawl waste	Block filter, sort and internal search URLs
Index bloat	Noindex or remove thin, duplicate and tag pages
JavaScript SEO	Put key content and links in the HTML, not only in JS
Canonicals	Point duplicate versions to one preferred URL
Content pruning	Merge or refresh decayed pages instead of keeping them

NOTE Crawl budget mostly matters for large or fast-changing sites (thousands of URLs). **Smaller stores should fix quality first.**

FEWER, STRONGER PAGES BEAT MORE PAGES.



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AI SEARCH OPTIMISATION

LEVEL: ADVANCED ●●●

AI search (Google AI Overviews and AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity) **pulls passages and cites sources**. Optimise to get cited.

HOW AI ANSWERS WORK

FAN-OUT
One question becomes many sub-searches

→

RETRIEVE
The best passages from many sites

→

CITE
Clear, trusted sources get linked

AEO / GEO TACTICS

- Answer first in 40–60 words, then add depth
- Cover the sub-questions fan-out will trigger
- Add original data, tests and first-hand experience
- Earn brand mentions on trusted third-party sites
- Keep facts the same across your site and profiles
- Let the AI crawlers you want in via robots.txt

RANKINGS BRING TRAFFIC. CITATIONS BUILD TRUST.



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PERMANENT SEO

ADVANCED CHECKLIST

YOUR STORE IS ADVANCED WHEN IT HAS:

1. A topical map with source context and a central entity
2. Content rich in entities, attributes and values
3. Entity schema with @id, sameAs and author pages
4. Internal links planned by topic hierarchy
5. Log files reviewed, crawl waste and index bloat fixed
6. Passages written for AI citation and information gain

LEARNING SEO?

Comment **ADVANCED**

STORE OWNER?

DM **AUDIT**

BASICS RANK. ADVANCED WINS.



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